# Almaz Isakov

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Product design leader with 10+ years of experience designing and scaling products across E-commerce, Foodtech, Fintech, B2B and Productivity systems. My design expertise and experience building creative teams and design practices enable me to drive impact at every level – from hands-on execution and mentoring designers to shaping product direction and scaling design operations

## EXPERIENCE

### Lead Product Designer at Halyk Market

June 2024 ⟶ Present

Top 3 universal marketplaces in Kazakhstan, part of the Halyk Bank ecosystem (8M+ MAU) – the country's largest bank by assets

Leading end-to-end experience for the Marketplace, e-Grocery, Internal tools, and B2B systems:

- Revamped Checkout experience resulting in a simpler user journey:
  - Reduced Time-To-Value by ~25%
  - Increased conversion rate ~4.5%.
- Successfully led design team through the product's largest design overhaul since inception, resulting in a 11% increase in CES
- Strengthened the design capability within the product:
  - Rebuilt the design team, improving delivery speed, quality, and depth of solutions while increasing overall cost-effectiveness
  - 1.5x faster Time-To-Market by introducing structured design processes and artefacts (documentation, regular syncs, reviews, Design QA), which reduced QA cycles and streamlined delivery
  - 2x faster Time-To-Market by embedding AI tools into the design production pipeline, reducing manual workload and lowering production costs

### Lead Product Designer at 360.tech

August 2022 ⟶ February 2024

DOSCREDOBANK's IT lab driving bank's digital transformation

Led a team of 4 product designers across multiple marketplace streams (customer, internal tools & B2B), owning quality, delivery, and collaboration with PM and engineering stakeholders

- 90% on-time delivery rate achieved through end-to-end planning and execution of webview experience overhaul for the marketplace
- 2x faster Time-To-Market by standardizing core design rituals (documentation, reviews, Design QA, and regular syncs), which improved delivery predictability and cut rework
- Mentored designers through regular 1:1s and critique sessions, raising the overall bar for interaction and visual design quality and promoting consistent patterns across product streams

## EDUCATION

### Jusup Balasagyn Kyrgyz National University

2012

Specialist in Risk Management, Business Economics

## SKILLS

UX design, UI design, Product design, System thinking, Product thinking, Human Centered Design, JBTD, CJM, Design Systems, AI tools, Prompt Engineering, Design Operations, Design management, Design strategy, Design thinking, User research, Usability testing, Art directing, Prototyping, Interaction design

## TOOLS

Figma; Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign; Affinity; Recraft, Weavy, Perplexity, MCPs, Notion; JIRA, Confluence

## LANGUAGES

Russian, native
English, B1

## HONORS & AWARDS

### Gold in Craft: Illustration & 3D at Jolbors - International Festival of Creativity

2016

Balaty – a social project of printed and Telegram sticker packs, with free sets distributed openly and paid ones raising funds for orphanages

## EXPERIENCE

### Senior Product Designer at 360.tech

July 2021 → August 2022

Led design for internal (inventory & content management) and B2B systems supporting the marketplace ecosystem:

- Designed and launched Seller Cabinet MVP which got over 50% of sellers approval for MVP workflow adoption
- ~80% Task Success rate on main workflows (product listing, order tracking)

### Product Designer at DOSCREDOBANK

August 2020 → July 2021

Top 5 bank of Kyrgyzstan in Customer Experience Index (2023)

Led design for internal tools (inventory & content management) and foundational systems powering the bank's marketplace and web ecosystem:

- Designed and launched Product Inventory Management System (Admin Panel MVP)
- 3x faster content operations (product listing, task tracking)
- 90% Task Success rate on main workflows (product listing, attributes and catalog management)

### Co-Founder, Multidisciplinary Designer at Art Collective C

February 2015 → August 2020

Independent art collective producing multimedia projects (editorial and digital longreads, art works, exhibitions, documentary photo & video)

Led visual identity and multi-channel communication design for an independent art collective, shaping how projects were presented across digital, editorial, and exhibition formats:

- Curated the country's first multimedia exhibition by Kyrgyz artists – a year-long show that attracted over 1,000+ visitors per day throughout its run
- Created site-specific installation "Emergency Exit" during an art residency in Chișinău, Moldova

### Graphic Designer at Mozgami Studio

August 2015 → December 2018

Mozgami – Kyrgyzstan's top-ranked design studio specializing in brand identity and communication design

Designed visual identities, advertising campaigns, infographics, and print collateral for clients across FMCG, automotive, finance, and nonprofit sectors

- Launched and managed UX/UI as a new service at the studio, increasing project revenue and expanding the studio's offering
- Ideated and co-produced the "Balaty" project, which won a Gold award (Craft: Illustration & 3D category) at the Jolbors International Festival of Creativity, earning significant recognition for the studio